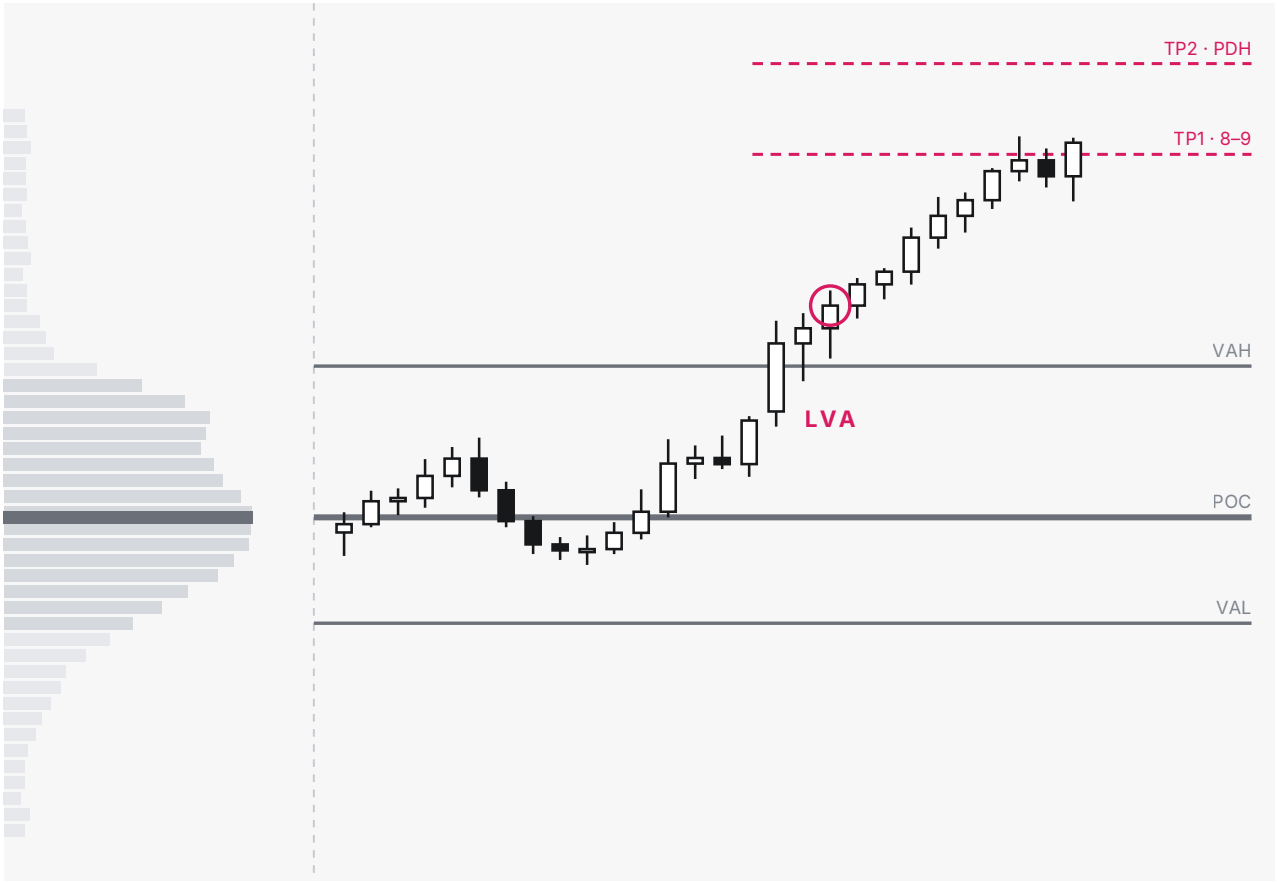
R3M



GUIDE

lava·

Value Area · Acceptance · Liquidity Ladder

EDITION	PLATFORM	SCRIPTS
October 2026	TradingView · Pine Script v6	lava· · lava·screener·

LAVA· GUIDE

Contents

01 **What lava does** 3
Where business was done, and where it goes next

02 **Quick start** 5
Three checks, then let it run

03 **The map** 6
Value area, nodes, the ladder's rungs

04 **The LVA** 8
Break, acceptance, entry, stop

05 **The target ladder** 10
TP1 on a real level, TP2 one rung on

06 **Tags, checklist and Edge Score** 12
What the entry carried, and what it was worth

07 **The scoreboard** 15
Every entry counted

08 **The status readout and the views** 16
Up to nine lines, top centre

09 **The liquidity** 18
Runs, equal levels, the draw

10 **Everything on the chart** 19
A legend from top to bottom

11 **The settings** 20
Ten groups, every input with its default

12 **Setting up alerts** 25
One message per entry, one per result

13 **The screener · lava·screener·** 27
Twelve symbols, one alert, one ranking

14 **The evidence** 30
What the replay showed, and what is switched off

15 **What the chart does not show** 32
Rules behind the display

IMPORTANT **This guide explains a tool, not a trading strategy**

lava (R3M) measures and names what the market has already done. It does not predict what it will do. Every number in this guide is a default, not a law. The defaults come from a replay on twelve Pepperstone symbols over eleven weeks — a sample, not a proof, and not optimised for your market. None of it is investment advice. The scoreboard counts your history; the Saturday report and the live forward test decide what holds.

SECTION 1

01 What lava does

lava reads the morning's auction and trades the moment price leaves it for good. It freezes the day's value area at 08:00, waits for London to accept a break of it, and aims the trade at the next place where business was done or where orders rest.

→ The one core idea 3
→ What sets lava apart 4
→ What you need 4

Question	The indicator's answer	When
1 · Where was business done?	The **map**: the day's volume profile frozen at 08:00 Berlin — POC, VAH, VAL, high and low volume nodes — plus the previous day's value area, PDH / PDL, the previous week's high / low, the PD 25 % / 50 %, the projections, the 8–9 range, the VWAP and the open liquidity.	From the freeze at 08:00
2 · Has price left it for good?	The **LVA** — London Value Acceptance: a close beyond the frozen VAH or VAL, and two more closes beyond it. The entry is the last of them, stop back inside.	09:00–11:00 on the London clock, once a day
3 · Where does it go?	The **liquidity ladder**: TP1 on the nearest real level at least 1R and at most 3R away, TP2 on the next one at least 1R beyond. Plus the **checklist** with the **Edge Score**, and the **scoreboard**, which says how such trades have run on this market so far.	With the entry, then live until TP, stop or end of day

The indicator does not trade on its own and gives no buy or sell recommendation. It draws the map, names the trade, keeps a checklist and counts. The decision stays with you.

The one core idea

> **NOTE** **Value is where the market agreed. Acceptance is where it agrees next.**
>
> Auction market theory reads a session as a search for a fair price. The value area — the range in which about 70 % of the volume traded — is where buyers and sellers agreed. As long as price rotates inside it, nothing has been decided. When price closes outside it and *stays* there for a few bars, the market has accepted a new price: the old agreement is over, and price tends to travel to the next place where it will find business (a node, a POC, a prior value area) or resting orders (a run of highs or lows). lava trades exactly that journey — and only from the first, cleanest acceptance of the morning.

What sets lava apart

equinox reads the day from the previous candle's bias, climax fades the exhausted extreme. lava asks a third question that neither asks: did the market leave the morning's value and accept the new price? It is the third workhorse next to equinox and climax, with its own trigger, its own stop logic and its own targets. Its liquidity engine is the one climax and lrlr· run (low-resistance runs, equal highs and lows, turtle-soup HRLR), copied verbatim, and its rolling VWAP is climax's.

What you need

- A chart with volume. On CFDs this is tick volume — enough for the profile, since only the shape matters.
- A 3-minute chart for the defaults (the replay ran on 3m). Any minute chart up to 1 hour works; the 1st presented FVG is always read on 1-minute data.
- The London morning: the value area freezes at 08:00 Berlin, entries run 09:00–11:00 Berlin.
- For a whole watchlist on one alert: lava·screener· (section 14).

SECTION 2

02 Quick start

→ Step 1 · Put it on a 3m chart 5
→ Step 2 · Check the freeze 5
→ Step 3 · Pick the view 5
→ What you see on the first morning 5

Step 1 · Put it on a 3m chart

Add lava· to a 3-minute chart of a market that trades in the London morning — an index, an FX pair, gold. Leave the defaults. They are lava v0.2: value area acceptance only, the London clock, the window until 11:00, TP1 at most 3R, the Lean target ladder.

Step 2 · Check the freeze

At 08:00 Berlin the solid `VAH`, `VAL` and `POC` lines appear, with the nodes (`HVN` solid and thicker, `LVN` dashed). From now on they do not move. If no lines appear, the chart has no bars before 08:00 on that day (the freeze only arms after a bar before it) or `Draw Value Areas & Nodes` is off. Without volume every bar counts as one, so the profile becomes a time profile.

Step 3 · Pick the view

`View` in group 5d decides how much the status readout, the checklist and the scoreboard show: Simple (what you need to act), Standard (the default, plus context) or Full (everything). Section 9 shows all three.

What you see on the first morning

Dotted lines from the day's start: the previous day's value area (`PD VAH`, `PD VAL`, `PD POC`) and, with the extra rungs on, `PWH` / `PWL`, `25%` / `50%` and the projections `PDH +25%` … `PDL −50%`. At 08:00 the frozen value area. At 09:00 the dashed `LON 8–9.H` / `.L`. Shortly after 09:00, if one prints, the 1st presented FVG with its tag `1st +FVG` or `1st -FVG`. Then, on an acceptance, the mark `▲ lava` below the bar (`▼ lava` above for a short), a dotted stop line and the two target lines with `TP1 1.8R` and `TP2 4.1R`.

SECTION 3

03 The map

→ The frozen value area 6
→ Nodes 6
→ The previous day 6
→ The extra rungs 6
→ The 8–9 range 7
→ The VWAP 7
→ The 1st presented FVG 7

The frozen value area

lava builds the day's volume profile from every bar since the day began: each bar's volume is spread evenly over the price rows its range covers (`Rows` , 101). The **POC** is the row with the most volume. The **value area** grows from the POC towards the heavier neighbour row until it holds `Value Area (%)` of the day's volume (70). Its edges are **VAH** and **VAL**.

At `Freeze At` (08:00, Europe/Berlin) the profile stops counting. Only the bars before the freeze count, so nothing after it can move the levels the trigger reads. The lines run 16 hours from the freeze.

Nodes

A **high volume node** (`HVN`) is a row that is the highest within `Node Neighbour Rows` (3) on both sides, holds at least `HVN At Least (% Of POC)` (60 %) of the POC row, and stands out from its neighbours by `Node Prominence` (1.5×). It is where business was done — a magnet that slows price. A **low volume node** (`LVN`) is the mirror: a valley below 35 % of the POC that price passed through rather than traded. Price tends to run across it. At most `Nodes Per Kind` (3) of each are kept, the clearest first.

The previous day

At the day's start the previous day's whole profile is read the same way: `PD VAH` , `PD VAL` , `PD POC` and its nodes. They are rungs of the ladder, and the entry is tagged by where it fired — `inside PD VA` or `outside PD VA` .

The extra rungs

With `Targets · PWH / PWL, 25% / 50%, Projections` on (default), the ladder gets more rungs so a target lands on a real level instead of far away in nowhere:

Rung	What it is
PDH / PDL	The previous day's high and low (always on).
PWH / PWL	The previous week's high and low.
25% / 50%	The PD quarter levels as in equinox and climax: from the previous day's close towards the extreme it left.

Rung	What it is
PDH +25% / +50%, PDL −25% / −50%	The projections of the previous day's range.

↳ `Draw` draws them as dotted lines (with `Draw Value Areas & Nodes` on); switched off, they still count as targets.

The 8–9 range

The high and low of 08:00–09:00 Berlin, drawn dashed from 09:00 as `LON 8–9.H` / `.L`. The New York clock's own range, 08:00–09:00 New York (14:00–15:00 Berlin), is drawn the same way as `NY 8–9.H` / `.L` and stays until the next New York 08:00 — so during the London morning it is yesterday's. Both are target rungs and context, not triggers (section 15). The LVA window only opens once the London 8–9 range is complete.

The VWAP

The rolling VWAP of climax: a window of constant length carried along with price (about sixty bars of the chart), never reset, with three band pairs at 0.5, 1 and 2 standard deviations. ↳ `Type` switches to `Day (Anchored)`: it starts fresh with every new day and grows through it. The midline colours by the side price is on. The entry is tagged `VWAP with` or `VWAP against`; the VWAP Gate (off by default) can make it a filter.

The 1st presented FVG

The first 1-minute fair value gap after the London open, its middle candle 09:01–11:30 Berlin, one per day — read on 1-minute data whatever the chart timeframe. It is drawn as long as the value area lines: distal and proximal dotted, the C.E. (its middle) fainter, a faint fill and the tag `1st +FVG` or `1st -FVG`. A close through its far side turns it into an iFVG with the opposite direction (`1st +iFVG` / `1st -iFVG`). With the `New York Clock` on, New York gets its own: the first gap after 09:30 New York, tagged `NY 1st +FVG` / `NY 1st -FVG`, and a New York entry is tagged by that one. With the New York clock off (default) there is none.

It is not a trigger. It tells the entry what the first displacement of the London open did: an LVA *against* the 1st FVG's birth direction — the first gap was the Judas move, the acceptance runs the other way — paid clearly more in the replay than one along it.

SECTION 4

04 The LVA

→ The break 8
→ The acceptance 8
→ The stop 8
→ One a day, one at a time 8
→ What is switched off 9

The break

From 09:00 until `Window Until` (11:00) on the London clock (Berlin hours), every close is checked against the frozen VAH and VAL. A close more than `Break Buffer (× ATR)` (0.1 ATR(14)) beyond an edge starts a **break**. From then on lava follows two numbers: the furthest price beyond the level, and the deepest pull-back towards it.

The acceptance

The break becomes an **acceptance** when `↳ Acceptance · Closes Beyond` (2) further closes print beyond the level. The entry is the close of the last of them. A close back inside the value area before that ends the break; the next close beyond starts a new one.

> **TIP** **Why closes, not touches**
>
> One close outside the value area is a probe. Further closes beyond it, without a close back inside, mean the market is doing business at the new price. A wick beyond the edge counts for nothing.

The stop

The stop sits behind the pullback since the break, at least on the far side of the level, plus `Stop Buffer (× ATR)` (0.25). For a long: the lower of the deepest pullback and the VAH, minus a quarter ATR. It is never closer than `↳ Min Risk (× ATR)` (0.5 ATR) — a tighter stop is pushed out to that.

One a day, one at a time

One LVA entry per day on the London clock. While a trade is live — before TP1, or after TP1 until TP2 or the day end — no new one starts. An acceptance that gives no entry — no target in range (section 5), a live trade, the VWAP Gate — uses up only that break: a later break the same morning can still enter.

What is switched off

The model can do more, and the switches stay for the next replay: `Failed Breakout` (a close beyond that comes back inside within N bars — the 80 % rule, back into value), `Levels` `8–9 Range` or `Both` (the 8–9 range as the broken level), the `New York Clock` with its own window and its own value area frozen at 08:00 New York, and the `VWAP Gate`. In the replay none of them paid (section 15). With all of them on, the same eleven weeks lost money.

SECTION 5

05 The target ladder

→ How TP1 and TP2 are chosen 10
→ The rungs 10
→ Target Ladder: Lean or v0.2 11
→ The trade's life 11
→ What is drawn 11

How TP1 and TP2 are chosen

At the entry lava collects every rung ahead in the trade's direction: the frozen nodes, POC and VA edges, the previous day's, the 8–9 range, PDH / PDL, the open LRLR / EQH / EQL on that side, an HRLR that became the draw, and — with the extra rungs — PWH / PWL, 25 % / 50 % and the projections.

- **TP1** is the nearest rung at least `TP1 At Least (R)` (1R) away.
- **No entry** if that rung is further than `TP1 At Most (R)` (3R). A target far away in nowhere rarely gets hit.
- **TP2** is the nearest rung at least 1R beyond TP1.

The message names the rung TP1 sits on: `accept·VA→8–9`, `→PD`, `→25%`, …

The rungs

Name in the message	Rung
`HVN`	a high volume node (today's frozen, the previous day's)
`POC`	a point of control
`VA`	a value area edge (today's or the previous day's)
`LRLR`	an open LRLR
`EQ`	an open EQH or EQL
`8–9`	an 8–9 high or low (London's, or the New York clock's last one)
`PD`	PDH / PDL
`draw`	an HRLR that became the draw (section 10)
`PW`	PWH / PWL
`25% · 50%`	the PD quarter levels
`proj`	PDH / PDL ± 25 %
`proj50`	PDH / PDL ± 50 %

Some rungs paid better as TP1 than others in the replay — the 25 %, the 8–9, PDH / PDL, PWH / PWL, the draw and the HVN. That is the fourth component of the Edge Score (section 7).

Target Ladder: Lean or v0.2

A target study on a second export (517 London VA acceptances, August 10 to October 20 2026, every level kind tested as the only target, net) sharpened the picture: the 8–9 range (Ø +0.53R) and EQH / EQL (+0.28R) paid most, PD VA, PDH / PDL and the PD 25 % held in both halves, LRLR flipped from +12R to −13R between the halves and the ±50 % projections lost in both. Volume nodes rarely sit ahead of an acceptance and did not stand out as targets. `Target Ladder` `Lean` leaves out LRLR, the draw, the PD 50 % and the ±50 % projections; in the study it was better in both halves and every month (+58.7R against +49.0R). The ±25 % projection stays on both: it was neutral overall (weak at 1–2R, positive at 2–3R), and leaving it out cost trades like the GER40 short of October 19 (+1.6R). A second export with the freeze at 09:00 agreed: Lean was ahead at both freeze times (08:00: +67.1R against +54.4R for v0.2, both halves; 09:00 was weaker for both, so the freeze stays at 08:00). Since October 20 2026 `Lean` is the default; `v0.2` keeps every rung.

The trade's life

State	When	Glyph
Live	from the entry	●
TP1 Hit	the high (long) touched TP1 — by touch, not by close	◆
TP2 Hit	TP2 touched, also straight from Live	◈
Stopped	a close through the stop before TP1 — a wick does not stop	○
Expired	the day ended before a target	○

After TP1 the status only moves forward: the stop no longer counts, the trade waits for TP2 or the day end. Stop on close, target on touch — as in equinox and climax.

What is drawn

`Draw Entries, Stops & Targets` (on): the mark `▲ lava` / `▼ lava` at the entry bar — its tooltip is the full alert text — a dotted stop line, and TP1 / TP2 as thick lines with their R (`TP1 1.8R`), each twelve bars long. Long and short take their own colour (white and dark grey by default); the stop stays neutral.

SECTION 6

06 Tags, checklist and Edge Score

Every entry is tagged with what surrounded it. The tags travel in the alert, in the archive and in the replay export, so every one of them can be counted. The checklist shows them for the latest entry; four of them make the Edge Score.

→ The tags 12
→ The Edge Score 12
→ The checklist 13
→ Pro and contra · gaps, taps and the climax 13

The tags

Tag	Meaning
🏅 `edge 3/4`	the Edge Score (below)
`VWAP with` · `VWAP against`	the entry was on the trade's side of the VWAP or not
`flow with` · `flow against`	the previous day's candle (bull: closed above its open) pointed the trade's way or not — absent on a doji day or with Order Flow off
`LVN in path`	a low volume node between entry and TP1
`HVN in path`	a high volume node or a POC between entry and TP1
`HRLR in path`	a protected HRLR between entry and TP1
`inside PD VA` · `outside PD VA`	where the entry fired relative to the previous day's value area
`1st FVG with` · `1st FVG against` · `no 1st FVG yet`	today's 1st presented FVG, by its direction at birth
`1st iFVG`	it had inverted before the entry
`TP1 at 8–9`	the rung TP1 sits on

The Edge Score

The Edge Score counts how many of the four tags that paid in the replay the entry carries — 0 to 4:

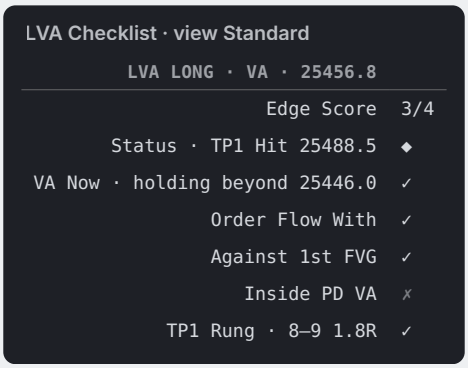
Component	Replay, net, per trade
Order Flow With	Ø +0.15R with, +0.09R against (188 / 285)
Against 1st FVG	Ø +0.20R against, +0.03R with or none yet (160 / 313)
Inside PD VA	Ø +0.17R inside, +0.06R outside (223 / 250)
TP1 Rung (25 %, 8–9, PD, PW, draw, HVN)	Ø +0.24R, against Ø 0.00R for the other rungs (223 / 250)

By score, the 473 LVAs of the replay: 0 → Ø −0.27R · 1 → +0.06R · 2 → +0.16R · 3 → +0.19R · 4 → +0.90R. It rises in both halves of the replay; from 2 up the two halves gave +26.2R and +26.1R, below 2 together about zero.

> **IMPORTANT** **Information, not a gate**
>
> Every LVA still fires, whatever its score. The paying rungs were picked on the whole replay, so the score is partly fitted to it. It runs as a candidate filter (`LVA only with an Edge Score of 2+`) in the Saturday rule check; it moves into the script only after four weeks of 🟢 on live alerts.

The checklist

Top right sits the checklist of the latest entry. An example in the Standard view:



The header names the setup, direction, level family and entry; its tooltip gives the time, entry, stop, risk, TP1 with its R and rung, TP2 and the edge it accepted. Below it:

- **Edge Score** with its count. In Simple its tooltip lists the four components with ✅ / ❌.
- **Status** with the state, the price that decided it and the glyph — live.
- **VA Now** — live: ✓ price still holds beyond the edge the entry accepted, × it is back inside the value area. The breakout is failing; the stop is not hit yet, but the acceptance is gone.
- The **four edge components** (Standard and Full): the snapshot the entry fired with.
- The **pro / contra rows** (Standard and Full): Taps, Gap In Path, Entry At Gap, Climax — see below.
- In Full also the tag rows, muted: `VWAP With` , `LVN In Path` , `HVN In Path` , `HRLR In Path` , `1st iFVG` .

Simple shows the header, the score, the status and VA Now. `LVA Checklist` sets the position (Top Left, Top Right, Middle Right, Bottom Left, Bottom Right), ↳ `Edge Score` switches the score row off — and the `Edge n/4` in the readout's entry line.

Pro and contra · gaps, taps and the climax

From climax, lava carries the gap engine — HTF fair value gaps and the NWOG / NDOG opening gaps — with its first taps, and the climax bar. They do not move the Edge Score and stay out of the alert (so the screener's messages stay word for word the same); they speak in the checklist, the readout and the entry tooltip, and they are exported for the replay.

Row	✓ pro	× contra
Taps · 2↓ 0↑	more first taps in the entry's 7h block back the trade (↓ from above backs a long, ↑ a short)	more stand against it
Gap In Path	no opposing gap between entry and TP1	an opposing HTF FVG or an opening gap on the way
Entry At Gap	the entry sits in (or within 0.5 ATR of) a gap pointing its way, or an opening gap	—
Climax	the day's latest climax printed at the extreme the trade leaves (the day low for a long: the sellers ran out)	at the extreme it runs into (buyers exhausted at the high, for a long)

The **climax** (ϟ) is climax's exhaustion bar: at least 2× ATR wide on the climax timeframe (Auto: 10m on a 3m chart), a new day high or low, a close back in its opposite half. lava has no bias engine, so instead of climax's 25 % readings it names the lava level the bar poked through and closed back from — `at the PDH`, `at the VAH`, `at the 8–9 high` … The **taps** are counted per 7h block of the London clock (18:00 · 01:00 · 08:00 · 15:00 Berlin), ☐ marks each first tap on the chart.

SECTION 7

07 The scoreboard

Bottom right by default, the scoreboard counts every lava entry since the chart's first bar:

Scoreboard · view Full (example)

```
                          lava · 54 days · 41 entries
          TP1 54% · TP2 29% · stopped 39% · Σ +9.6R
                                          ──────────
     edge 3–4 · 9 · TP1 67% · stopped 22% · Σ +6.1R
      edge 2 · 15 · TP1 53% · stopped 40% · Σ +3.2R
    edge 0–1 · 17 · TP1 47% · stopped 47% · Σ +0.3R
                                          ──────────
Order Flow With · ✓ Ø +0.35R (18) · ✗ Ø +0.14R (23)
Against 1st FVG · ✓ Ø +0.44R (12) · ✗ Ø +0.15R (29)
   Inside PD VA · ✓ Ø +0.29R (20) · ✗ Ø +0.18R (21)
TP1 Paying Rung · ✓ Ø +0.36R (19) · ✗ Ø +0.12R (22)
       VWAP With · ✓ Ø +0.23R (38) · ✗ Ø +0.30R (3)
```

- **Line 1**: days loaded and entries.
- **Line 2**: TP1 / TP2 = share that touched the first / second target, stopped = closed through the stop before TP1; the rest expired or are live. Σ is **gross**: TP1 hit = its R, stopped = −1R, expired = 0, without spread and commission. The Saturday report and the Riff count net.
- **By Edge Score** (Standard and Full): the same for the bands 3–4, 2, 0–1. If the score means anything on your market, these rows rise from the bottom up.
- **By component** (Full): R gross per entry where the component was ✓ against ×, with the counts. A component earns its place when ✓ beats × by a margin the sample size carries.

The numbers above are an example. On a 3m chart TradingView loads a few weeks; the scoreboard is your market's own small sample.

SECTION 8

08 The status readout and the views

Top centre by default (or bottom centre, with the `Status Readout` position in group 5d). An example from the Full view, mid-morning after a long:

```
lava · GER40 · 3m · London
VA 25402.0 – 25446.0 · POC 25428.0 · Above VA
LVA Window 09:00–11:00 · taken 09:24
Flow BULL · VWAP above · above PD VA
1st +iFVG 25431.5 – 25437.0 · 09:03
LON 8–9 25398.5 – 25488.5 · inside
PD VA 25365.0 – 25450.0 · PD POC 25410.0
Liquidity · ↑ +LRLR 25512.5 · ↓ EQL 25421.0
LVA LONG · VA 25456.8 · TP1 Hit · Edge 3/4
```

Line	Meaning
Context	Name, symbol, timeframe and the clock (`+ New York` with the New York clock on). Only in Full.
Value area	The frozen VAL – VAH and POC, and where the close sits: `Inside VA` , `Above VA` , `Below VA` . During a break `· ▲ accepting 1/2` counts the closes beyond. Before the freeze: `VA · builds until 08:00` .
Window	`opens 09:00` , `waits for the 8–9` , `open` , `taken 09:24` , `closed` . Bright while open.
Context line	Order flow (the previous day's candle), the side of the VWAP, the position against the PD value area. From Standard.
1st FVG	Today's 1st presented FVG with its zone, direction, `iFVG` once inverted, and the time — or `waiting (09:01–11:30)` , `none today` . From Standard.
8–9	The London 8–9 range and where price sits. Only in Full.
PD VA	The previous day's value area and POC. Only in Full.
Gaps	The nearest live gap above (↑) and below (↓) and the taps of the running 7h block (`taps 2↓ 0↑`). From Standard.
Climax	Today's latest climax: `ϟ day low 25181.0 · at the PDL 25193.9 · 2.3× ATR (10m)` . From Standard, when there is one.
Liquidity	The nearest open LRLR / EQH / EQL above (↑) and below (↓), or an HRLR once it is the draw (◎). From Standard.
Entry	Setup, entry, status and Edge Score — or `No lava entry yet` . In Simple with stop and targets. Bright while the trade is live.

Every line explains itself on hover, with the numbers behind it.

The three views

View	Readout	Checklist	Scoreboard
Simple	value area · window · entry with its levels	header · Edge Score · Status · VA Now	two lines
Standard (default)	+ context · 1st FVG · liquidity	+ the four edge components	+ by Edge Score
Full	+ header · 8–9 · PD VA	+ the tag rows	+ by component

Everything keeps running in every view; the view only decides what is on the chart.

SECTION 9

09 The liquidity

lava carries the liquidity engine of climax and lrlr·, copied verbatim. In lava it serves two purposes: open levels are rungs of the target ladder, and a protected HRLR in the trade's way is tagged.

→ Low-resistance runs · LRLR 18
→ HRLR and the draw 18
→ What you see 18

Low-resistance runs · LRLR

A series of lower highs with no open bearish FVG between them: liquidity rests above them, and price meets little resistance running up into it (`+LRLR`). Mirrored: higher lows with no open bullish FVG (`-LRLR`). A swing needs `Swing Bars Left` / `↳ Right` (5 / 5) to be confirmed, a run `Min Swings In Run` (3). Chart FVGs smaller than `Breaking FVG Min Size (× ATR)` (0.3) do not break a run; with `Only Open FVGs Break It` (on) a gap price already filled again is no resistance either. **EQH / EQL**: two swings in a row within `Tolerance (Ticks)` (10).

HRLR and the draw

With `HRLR` on `Turtle Soup + Breakers` (default): a swing high is run by a wick and the bar closes back below it (turtle soup), then price leaves with displacement, closing through the last swing low within `↳ Displacement Within (Bars)` (10). The swept extreme is a **high-resistance** level (`+HRLR` , dashed and paler); a body close beyond the swept swing before the displacement cancels the soup. Like any level, the HRLR counts as run once price touches it. Once an LRLR on the other side is taken, the HRLR stops resisting and becomes the **draw** (◎, solid): the next target. `Behind An Open FVG` is the older gaps· mode, with group 4's HTF FVGs.

What you see

`Draw Levels & Tags` (on): a line at the outermost swing of each run, the swings joined by a dotted line, faded once run and extended `Extension After Run (Bars)` (5) past the bar that took it. `Keep Per Type · Live` (10) and `↳ History` (20) cap how many are kept. The nearest open levels sit in the readout's Liquidity line.

SECTION 10

10 Everything on the chart

What	Looks like	Section
`VAH` · `VAL`	solid, from 08:00 for 16 hours	3
`POC`	solid, thick	3
`HVN` · `LVN`	solid thick · dashed	3
`PD VAH` · `PD VAL` · `PD POC`	dotted, from the day's start	3
`PWH` · `PWL` · `25%` · `50%` · `PDH +25%` …	dotted, paler	3
`LON 8–9.H` · `NY 8–9.L` …	dashed, from 08:00 to three hours after 09:00 of each clock	3
`1st +FVG` · `1st -iFVG`	dotted zone with C.E. and a faint fill	3
VWAP and bands	line coloured by side, three dotted band pairs	3
LRLR · EQH / EQL · HRLR	solid / dashed lines, swings joined dotted	10
`▲ lava` · `▼ lava`	the entry mark, tooltip = the alert	5
stop · `TP1 1.8R` · `TP2 4.1R`	dotted · thick lines, twelve bars	5
`ϟ`	the climax mark at the bar's extreme	7
`□`	first tap into a gap, above (↓) or below (↑) the bar	7
gap boxes · `4H -FVG` · `10/5 +NDOG`	off by default	7
status readout	top centre	9
LVA checklist	top right	7
scoreboard	bottom right	8

SECTION 11

11 The settings

To begin with, leaving the defaults in place is enough: they are v0.2, the setup the replay carried. Settings marked ↳ belong to the one above them and are greyed out while it is off.

→ 1 · Profile & Value Area 20
→ 2 · Triggers & Trades 21
→ 3 · Liquidity Runs 21
→ 4 · Gaps & Taps 22
→ 4b · Climax 22
→ 5 · Clock & Order Flow 23
→ 5b · Rolling VWAP 23
→ 5c · Visuals 23
→ 5d · View, Checklist & Status 23
→ 6 · Alerts 23

1 · Profile & Value Area

Setting	Default	What it does
Rows	101	20–300. How finely the day's range is cut into price rows.
Value Area (%)	70	30–95. Share of the volume the value area holds.
Freeze At	08:00 · Europe/Berlin	07:00–10:00 · Berlin, London, New York, UTC. From then on the value area stays put.
HVN At Least (% Of POC)	60	Minimum height of a high volume node.
LVN At Most (% Of POC)	35	Maximum height of a low volume node.
Node Neighbour Rows	3	Rows a node must beat on both sides; also the minimum distance between two nodes.
Node Prominence	1.5	How clearly a node must stand out from its neighbours.
Nodes Per Kind	3	HVN and LVN kept each, the clearest first.
New York Value Area	Since London Freeze	Since London Freeze · Whole Day · Off. The New York clock's own value area, frozen at 08:00 New York. Only with the New York clock on.
Draw Value Areas & Nodes	on	The value area lines, nodes, the PD levels, the extra rungs and the 8–9 ranges.
Draw 1st Presented FVG	on	The 1st FVG zone and tag (London's, and New York's with the New York clock on). The tags and the score read it either way.

2 · Triggers & Trades

Setting	Default	What it does
Acceptance · Failed Breakout	on · off	The two triggers. v0.2 runs acceptance only.
Levels	Value Area	Value Area · 8–9 Range · Both. Which levels can be broken.
↳ **Acceptance · Closes Beyond**	2	0–10. Further closes beyond the level after the break.
↳ **Failed · Back Inside Within (Bars)**	6	How soon a failed breakout must come back inside.
Break Buffer (× ATR)	0.1	How far beyond the level a close must be to count as a break.
Stop Buffer (× ATR)	0.25	Beyond the pullback and the level.
↳ **Min Risk (× ATR)**	0.5	The stop is never closer than this.
TP1 At Least (R)	1.0	TP1 is the nearest rung at least this far.
TP1 At Most (R)	3.0	No entry when the nearest TP1 is further. 0 = no limit.
Targets · PWH / PWL, 25% / 50%, Projections · Draw	on · on	The extra rungs; Draw shows them.
Target Ladder	Lean	Lean · v0.2 (without LRLR, draw, PD 50 %, ±50 % projections · section 5).
Window Until	11:00	10:30–15:00. Entries from 09:00 until then, Berlin hours.
New York Clock	off	Its own 8–9 range, window and value area on New York hours.
VWAP Gate	Off	Off · With VWAP (longs only above, shorts only below).
Draw Entries, Stops & Targets	on	With the long / short colours.

3 · Liquidity Runs

Setting	Default	What it does
Draw Levels & Tags	on	The LRLR / EQH / EQL / HRLR lines. The logic works without.
Swing Bars Left · ↳ Right	5 · 5	Bars that confirm a swing.
Min Swings In Run	3	Swings needed for a run.
Breaking FVG Min Size (× ATR)	0.3	Smaller chart FVGs do not break a run.
Only Open FVGs Break It	on	A gap already filled again does not break it.
HRLR	Turtle Soup + Breakers	· Behind An Open FVG · Off.
↳ **Displacement Within (Bars)**	10	Bars after the turtle soup for the displacement.

Setting	Default	What it does
↳ **Becomes The Draw Once The Opposite LRLR Is Taken**	on	The HRLR turns into the next target.
↳ **HTF FVG In Path Counts Too**	on	Behind An Open FVG only.
EQH / EQL · Tolerance (Ticks)	on · 10	Equal highs and lows.
Keep Per Type · Live · ↳ History	10 · 20	Levels kept, live and already run.
Extension After Run (Bars)	5	How far a run level still extends.
Tag Row Merge (× ATR)	0.5	Kept for the lrlr· layout.

4 · Gaps & Taps

From climax (section 7, Pro and contra).

Setting	Default	What it does
Gaps · HTF FVGs & Opening Gaps	on	The gaps as pro and contra for the LVA.
↳ **Draw Boxes & Tags**	off	The gaps as boxes with tags (4H -FVG · 10/5 +NDOG), merged into rows by `Tag Row Merge`.
↳ **☐ First Tap Marks**	on · 7H	☐ at the first tap into a gap; 7H = re-armed each 7h block of the London clock, Never = once.
↳ **Level Proximity (× ATR)**	0.5	How close a gap must be to the entry for Entry At Gap.
↳ **HTF FVGs**	on	Two layers matched to the chart (Automatic: 1m → 15m + 1H · 5m → 1H + 4H · 15m → 4H + 1D · 1H → 1D + 1W) or up to three manual ones · `FVGs Per Side` (3) · `Min Size (Ticks)` (4) · fill colours. They also feed the HRLR path rule.
↳ **Opening Gaps**	on	NWOG and NDOG, `Keep` 1 / 5, `Remove On Close Through` (off). US index CFDs read the 16:14 → 18:00 New York gap.
↳ **Box Extension (Bars)**	23	How far the boxes run to the right.

4b · Climax

Setting	Default	What it does
Climax Marks · ϟ	on	The mark; the climax is read for the checklist either way.
↳ **Climax Bar (× ATR)**	2.0	Minimum range in ATR(14) of the climax timeframe.
↳ **Climax Timeframe**	Auto	Chart · Auto · 1m … 1W. Auto: 3m → 10m, 5m → 15m, 15m → 1H, 1H → 4H.

5 · Clock & Order Flow

Setting	Default	What it does
Session Clock	London	The clock for the times in the tooltips (London runs on Berlin hours). The LVA always runs on the London clock.
Order Flow · PD Bias	on	The `flow with / against` tag from the previous day's candle.

5b · Rolling VWAP

Setting	Default	What it does
Rolling VWAP	on	With the midline colour.
↳ **Type**	Rolling	Rolling · Day (Anchored). The tags and the gate read it.
↳ **Colored Midline**	on	Above · touching · below.
↳ **Source**	hlc3	
↳ **Band 1 · 2 · 3**	0.5 · 1.0 · 2.0	σ multiples, 0 hides a pair.

5c · Visuals

`Monospace Font` (on), `Font Size` (Default; −2 to +3).

5d · View, Checklist & Status

Setting	Default	What it does
View	Standard	Simple · Standard · Full (section 9).
Status Readout	on · Top Center	or Bottom Center.
LVA Checklist	on · Top Right	Top Left · Top Right · Middle Right · Bottom Left · Bottom Right.
↳ **Edge Score**	on	The score row and the `Edge n/4` in the readout. The alert carries the score either way.
Scoreboard	on · Bottom Right	Bottom Left · Middle Right · Middle Left.

6 · Alerts

Setting	Default	What it does
Entries & Results	on	Every entry and its result.
Message Format	Telegram	Telegram · Plain Text.

Setting	Default	What it does
↳ **Telegram Chat ID**	preset	Your chat or channel ID.

SECTION 12

12 Setting up alerts

→ What a message looks like 25
→ Emojis in the messages 26
→ Message Format: Plain Text or Telegram 26

1. **Right-click the chart → Add alert.**
2. **Pick lava· as the condition, below it "Any alert() function call".**
3. **In the Notifications tab enter the webhook URL (Telegram) or set the format to Plain Text.**
4. **Save. After every change to the script: delete the alert and create it again.** A running alert computes with the state of the script from the moment it was created.

At most one message goes out per bar, at its close.

What a message looks like

The entry from the checklist above, at 09:24:

> **R3M Alerts**
> **GER40 · 3m · London · lava**
> 🧭 LVA London Value Acceptance ▲ VA · 🏅 edge 3/4 · VWAP with · flow with · LVN in path · outside PD VA · 1st FVG against · 1st iFVG · TP1 at 8–9
> 🟢 · LONG 25456.8 · SL 25439.0 · TP1 25488.5 (1.8R) · TP2 25530.0 (4.1R) · accept·VA→8–9
> 09:27

The header names symbol, timeframe, clock and script. The 🧭 **line** names the setup — `LVA London Value Acceptance` for the v0.2 model, `Acceptance` or `Failed breakout` for the switched-off ones — the direction and the level family (`VA` , `8–9` , `VA+8–9`), then the tags (section 7). The second paragraph: direction, entry, stop, targets with their R to one decimal, and the short code `accept·VA→8–9` (trigger · family → TP1's rung).

The result goes out alone:

> **R3M Alerts**
> **GER40 · 3m · London · lava**
> ✅ · LONG 25456.8 TP1 Hit 25488.5.
> 10:06

`🏆 · LONG 25456.8 TP2 Hit 25530.0.` · `🛑 · LONG 25456.8 Stopped · SL 25439.0.` An expiry at the day end sends nothing. If a result and a new entry fall on the same bar, they go out together, the result first.

Emojis in the messages

Emoji	Meaning	When
🧭	the setup and its tags	every entry
🏅	the Edge Score	every entry
🟢 · 🔴	long · short	the entry line
✅	TP1 hit	result
🏆	TP2 hit	result
🛑	stopped	result

Message Format: Plain Text or Telegram

Telegram is the default: the message is a ready-made `sendMessage` request for the Bot API, TradingView posts it unchanged to the webhook URL `https://api.telegram.org/bot<TOKEN>/sendMessage` (webhooks need a paid TradingView plan). The header becomes bold, the ticker links to the chart. For an ordinary TradingView alert — app, e-mail, alert log — set Plain Text: the header `GER40 · 3m · London · lava` on the first line, the message below. Set up bot, chat ID and webhook as described in the equinox guide; the chat ID goes into ↳ `Telegram Chat ID`.

> **TIP** **The archive reads it**
>
> The format is the archive format of equinox and climax. Every message lands in the R3M archive, the Saturday signal report evaluates it net of costs, and the tags — the Edge Score included — become columns that can be counted.

SECTION 13

13 The screener · lava·screener·

lava·screener· runs lava's LVA on up to twelve symbols from one chart. Every symbol gets the same read as lava itself — the value area frozen at 08:00, the acceptance from 09:00 to 11:00, the stop behind the pullback, the targets on the same ladder, the same tags and the same Edge Score. One alert covers the whole watchlist, and a table ranks the markets by how their LVAs have run.

→ Setting it up 27
→ The table 27
→ The ranking 28
→ Settings 29
→ Reports and alerts 29

Setting it up

Put it on a chart that trades nearly around the clock — EURUSD 3m. A symbol's bar is only seen when the chart has a bar at that time. Each symbol is read on the chart's timeframe with its own volume, its own previous day and week, and its own 1-minute data for the 1st FVG: two requests per symbol, 24 for a full watchlist. Keep groups 2–4 equal to lava's settings.

> **IMPORTANT** **Screener or lava·, not both**
>
> The screener sends every entry and result word for word in lava's format, with the symbol in the header. If lava's own alert runs on a symbol of the watchlist too, every message arrives twice. Use lava's alert for single charts, the screener for the watchlist.

The table

The table has up to twenty columns; here it is split in three for the page — on the chart it is one row per symbol.

lava·screener· · the record

#	symbol	runs	TP1	TP2	stop	ΣR	with	against
1	EURUSD	17	71%	35%	29%	+14	44% · 9	100% · 8
2	GBPUSD	14	64%	50%	29%	+10	43% · 7	86% · 7
3	US500	15	60%	40%	33%	+9.7	50% · 8	71% · 7

lava·screener· · the day

symbol	VA 08:00	8–9	ADR	1st FVG	price
EURUSD	↓ 1.12164 – 1.12241	▼ broke	64%	-iFVG 09:03	1.11903
GBPUSD	↓ 1.33258 – 1.33331	▼ broke	71%	-iFVG 09:03	1.33010
US500	↓ 7697.3 – 7726.4	inside	48%	+FVG 09:06	7697.1

lava·screener· · today's LVA

symbol	setup · 3m	since	status	R	liquidity
EURUSD	▼ accept·VA → proj · edge 2/4	09:09	TP1 Hit	2.2	→ EQL 1.4 ATR
GBPUSD	▼ accept·VA → 25% · edge 3/4	09:12	TP2 Hit	2	→ -LRLR 2.1 ATR
US500	·	·	·	·	↑ +LRLR 3.2 ATR

Column	Meaning
runs · TP1 · TP2 · stop · ΣR	The record over the loaded history: LVAs, share at TP1 / TP2 / stopped, R gross.
with · against	The record split by `With / Against` : TP1 rate and count of the LVAs whose 1st FVG pointed the trade's way, and of those against it (or by the VWAP side).
VA 08:00	The frozen value area, ↑ / ↓ when price is above or below it, `not frozen` before 08:00.
8–9	`inside` , `▲ broke` , `▼ broke` , `▲▼ both` .
ADR	How much of the average daily range the day has spent; ⊘ once it is used up.
ATR	Optional (off).
1st FVG	Today's 1st presented FVG, its direction, `iFVG` once inverted, its time.
setup · since · status · R	Today's LVA with its rung and Edge Score, when it fired, where it stands, R to TP1.
liquidity	The next open level with its distance in ATR: in the trade's direction (→) with an LVA today, otherwise on the side of the order flow (↑ / ↓). Grey beyond `Liquidity Grey Beyond (× ATR)` (5).
price	The last close.

Hover a row for the full trade with stop, TP1 and TP2. The heatmap (Dark / Light Panel) colours the rates by strength — TP1 against its chance, the risk against the distance to TP1 — paler with few runs.

The ranking

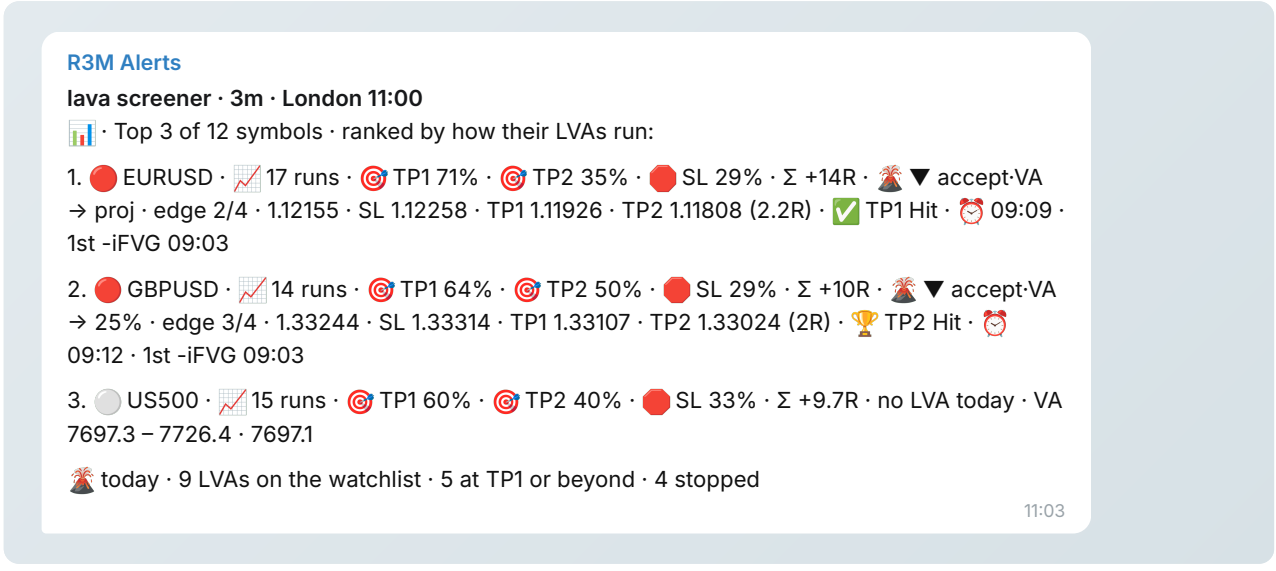
`LVA Performance` (default): TP1 rate minus stop rate over the record, TP2 rate as the tie-break; symbols with fewer than `Min Runs` (5) are `young` and sit at the bottom. `Today's Setup` : today's LVAs first, the newest on top.

Settings

Group	What is in it
1 · Watchlist	`Watchlist` Custom (twelve slots: GER40, UK100, EUSTX50, US500, NAS100, EURUSD, USDCHF, USDJPY, GBPUSD, XAUUSD, XAGUSD, SPOTCRUDE) or a preset: Forex, Indices, Commodities · Pepperstone, S&P 500 · Top 12, Nasdaq 100 · Next 12, DAX · Top 12, Futures · CME / Eurex, Crypto · Pepperstone, Crypto · Binance Perps.
2 · Profile & Value Area	As lava group 1, without the New York value area and the Draw switches.
3 · LVA Trades	As lava group 2 for acceptance (`Acceptance · Closes Beyond` without ↳), plus `Order Flow · PD Bias (tag)` and `VWAP Type (tag · gate)` .
4 · Liquidity Runs	As lava group 3 for the logic: `HRLR · Turtle Soup + Breakers` as an on / off switch with the draw, no drawing inputs.
5 · Table	`Table` , `Sort By` , `↳ Min Runs` , `With / Against` (1st FVG · VWAP), `Rows` , `Position` (Middle Center), `Width` , `Theme` (Dark Panel · Light Panel · Chart Ink), `↳ Heatmap` , fonts, the optional columns `with / against` , `8–9` , `ADR` , `ATR` (off), `liquidity` , and the colours.
6 · Alerts & Report	`Entries & Results` , `Top N In The Report` (3), `Report 1` 11:00, `Report 2` 17:30, `Message Format` , `↳ Telegram Chat ID` , `Send A Test Report On The Next Bar Close` , `Heartbeat Every Bar Close (Diagnostics)` .

Reports and alerts

One alert on the screener's chart, condition “Any alert() function call”. Every entry and result of every symbol goes out as its own message, exactly as lava sends it. Twice a day (11:00 and 17:30 Berlin, on the first bar close within 30 minutes of the time) the Top N go out as one report:



Each line: the direction (🟢 / 🔴, ⚪ without an LVA today), the symbol, the record, today's setup with its Edge Score, entry, stop and targets, the status (`⏳ Live` , `✅ TP1 Hit` , `🏆 TP2 Hit` , `🛑 Stopped` , `💤 Expired`), the time and the 1st FVG. The last line counts the day across the watchlist.
`Send A Test Report On The Next Bar Close` sends one at once, marked `🧪 test` — switch it off again afterwards.

SECTION 14

14 The evidence

The defaults are not opinions. They come from a replay of lava on twelve Pepperstone symbols (GER40, UK100, EUSTX50, US500, NAS100, EURUSD, USDCHF, USDJPY, GBPUSD, XAUUSD, XAGUSD, SPOTCRUDE), 3m, August 3 to October 19 2026, every R net of spread and commission, split into an in-sample and an out-of-sample half.

→ Everything on lost, the LVA won 30
→ Weak spots 30
→ What did not pay 31

Everything on lost, the LVA won

With every trigger, both level families, both clocks and the window until 12:00, lava lost about 53R in the same eleven weeks. Narrowed to the acceptance outside the frozen value area on the London clock, with TP1 at most 3R, the same data gave:

LVA · v0.2	Replay, net
Trades	473
TP1 or better · stopped · expired	47 % · 50 % · 3 %
Total	+52.9R (Ø +0.11R per trade, average TP1 1.6R)
The two halves	+33.8R · +19.1R
Weeks up	9 of 12
Months	August +11.7R · September +31.6R · October +9.5R

Weak spots

- **Shorts carried the sample.** 222 shorts gave +56.2R, 251 longs −3.3R. Eleven weeks of mostly falling mornings can do that; it is the first thing the live forward test watches.
- **Not every market pays.** EURUSD, USDCHF, GER40, US500 and NAS100 led; SPOTCRUDE lost 11.5R, USDJPY 1.5R. The Saturday report's playbook only keeps the cells that paid in both halves.
- **Costs bite on tight stops.** Ø 0.10R per trade went to spread and commission. USDX is context only: its spread is about 1.4R on a 3m stop.
- **The Edge Score is partly fitted** (section 7).

What did not pay

Switched off	Why
Failed Breakout	The 80 % rule back into value did not carry on its own. One combination held up in both halves — with the VWAP gate, on both clocks, 101 trades — too few to switch on yet.
8–9 Range as trigger	Did not pay. It stays a target rung.
New York Clock	Its own window and value area did not add.
VWAP Gate	446 of 473 LVAs are with the VWAP anyway; the gate filters almost nothing and dropped the best of the rest.

SECTION 15

15 What the chart does not show

→ 1 · The value area is frozen once 32
→ 2 · Stop on close, target on touch — after TP1 only forwards 32
→ 3 · One a day, one at a time 32
→ 4 · No target in range, no trade 32
→ 5 · The checklist is a snapshot 32
→ 6 · The 1st FVG is read on 1-minute data 32
→ 7 · The scoreboard is gross and short 33

1 · The value area is frozen once

At the freeze the profile of the bars before it is cut and kept. A bar after 08:00 never moves VAH, VAL or POC. The previous day's profile is the whole previous day.

2 · Stop on close, target on touch — after TP1 only forwards

A wick through the stop does not stop the trade, a close does. A wick to TP1 counts. After TP1 the stop no longer applies; the trade waits for TP2 or the day end.

3 · One a day, one at a time

One LVA entry per day on the London clock. Once one has fired, a second break the same morning is not traded, even after the first trade has ended.

4 · No target in range, no trade

When the nearest rung is closer than 1R the next one is taken; when that is further than 3R, that break is used up without an entry — a later break the same morning can still give one. The readout shows `taken` only after an entry.

5 · The checklist is a snapshot

The tags and the Edge Score are read the moment the entry fires. Only `Status` and `VA Now` move afterwards.

6 · The 1st FVG is read on 1-minute data

Whatever the chart timeframe, the 1st presented FVG comes from the 1-minute candles. On a 3m chart its tag can appear a bar after its 1m middle candle printed.

7 · The scoreboard is gross and short

It counts what the chart has loaded — a few weeks on a 3m chart — and without costs. For the long record and net R: the replay, the Saturday report, the Riff.

R 3 M

lava·

Value Area · Acceptance · Liquidity Ladder

R3M · lava· and lava·screener· for TradingView (Pine Script v6) · Edition October 2026

Concepts: auction market theory and the value area (J. Peter Steidlmayer, James Dalton), liquidity runs in ICT terms, turtle soup (Linda Raschke), the 1st presented FVG from 1st·. This guide explains a tool; it is not financial advice.